10. HTML — Forms

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A form collects input. `action` is the URL that receives it. `method="get"` puts the fields in the page address. `method="post"` puts them in the request body. Use `post` when the form creates or changes data, including a login. Each control has a `name`. That name is the key sent with the form.

`<label for>` matches the `id` of its control.

Text, password, and current input types

type	Purpose
`text`	A single line of text
`password`	A single line, characters hidden
`email`	An email address
`tel`	A telephone number
`url`	A web address
`search`	A search field
`number`	A number. `min` and `max` limit it
`range`	A number chosen on a slider
`date`, `time`, `datetime-local`, `month`, `week`	A date or a time
`color`	A colour
`checkbox`	A yes-or-no choice. Several boxes may share one `name`
`radio`	One choice in a group. The group shares one `name`
`file`	A file from the visitor's computer. `accept` lists the types
`hidden`	A value the visitor does not edit

`required` blocks submit until the field has a value. `placeholder` is a hint inside an empty field. The label remains. `autocomplete` names the saved value the browser may offer, such as `name` or `email`. `inputmode` asks the phone for a matching keyboard, such as `tel` or `numeric`. `minlength`, `maxlength`, and `pattern` constrain the text.

`<textarea>` is more than one line. It has an end tag. `<select>` is a menu of `<option>` elements. `<optgroup>` groups those options. `<datalist>` offers suggestions for a text field. `list` on the input names the datalist.

Buttons, groups, output, meter, and progress

Element	Purpose
`<button type="submit">`	Sends the form
`<button type="reset">`	Restores the initial values
`<button type="button">`	A button with no built-in form action
`<fieldset>` and `<legend>`	A group of controls and its name
`<output>`	A calculated result
`<meter>`	A value inside a known range
`<progress>`	Completion of a task

`<search>` wraps a search form.

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>Form Example</title>
</head>
<body>
  <form action="#" method="post" autocomplete="on">
    <p>
      <label for="full-name">Full name</label>
      <input id="full-name" name="full_name" type="text" autocomplete="name" required>
    </p>
    <p>
      <label for="email">Email</label>
      <input id="email" name="email" type="email" autocomplete="email" required>
    </p>
    <p>
      <label for="password">Password</label>
      <input id="password" name="password" type="password" autocomplete="new-password" required>
    </p>
    <p>
      <label for="phone">Mobile</label>
      <input id="phone" name="phone" type="tel" autocomplete="tel" inputmode="tel">
    </p>
    <p>
      <label for="qty">Quantity</label>
      <input id="qty" name="qty" type="number" min="1" max="10" value="1">
    </p>
    <p>
      <label for="join">Joining date</label>
      <input id="join" name="join_date" type="date">
    </p>
    <p>
      <label for="about">About you</label>
      <textarea id="about" name="about" rows="3"></textarea>
    </p>
    <fieldset>
```

```
      <legend>Batch mode</legend>
      <input id="mode-class" name="mode" type="radio" value="classroom" checked>
      <label for="mode-class">Classroom</label>
      <input id="mode-live" name="mode" type="radio" value="live">
      <label for="mode-live">Live online</label>
    </fieldset>
    <p>
      <input id="laptop" name="has_laptop" type="checkbox" value="yes">
      <label for="laptop">I have a laptop</label>
    </p>
    <p>
      <label for="track">Track</label>
      <select id="track" name="track">
        <option value="">Choose a track</option>
        <optgroup label="Full stack">
          <option value="python">Python</option>
          <option value="java">Java</option>
        </optgroup>
      </select>
    </p>
    <p>
      <label for="campus">Campus</label>
      <input id="campus" name="campus" type="text" list="campus-list">
      <datalist id="campus-list">
        <option value="Hyderabad">
        <option value="Bengaluru">
      </datalist>
    </p>
    <p>
      <label for="resume">Resume</label>
      <input id="resume" name="resume" type="file" accept=".pdf,application/pdf">
    </p>
    <input type="hidden" name="source" value="register-page">
    <p>Completion <progress value="40" max="100">40%</progress></p>
    <p>Score <meter min="0" max="100" low="40" high="80" optimum="90" value="72">72</meter></p>
    <p>Total <output name="total">0</output></p>
    <p>
      <button type="submit">Register</button>
      <button type="reset">Reset</button>
    </p>
  </form>
  <search>
    <form action="/menu" method="get">
      <label for="q">Find an item</label>
      <input id="q" name="q" type="search">
      <button type="submit">Search</button>
    </form>
  </search>
</body>
</html>
```

This will produce the following result:

Full name

Email

Password

Mobile

Quantity 1

Joining date dd/mm/yyyy

About you

Batch mode

Classroom Live online

I have a laptop

Track Choose a track

Campus

Resume Choose file No file chosen

Completion

Score

Total 0

Register Reset

Find an item Search